Dropbox Content Design Internship – Writing Sample 2
Project: AskBC AI Chatbot Prototype (2025)
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This writing sample demonstrates how I use in-product language, conversational structure, and trust-building microcopy to guide users through complex government workflows while reducing cognitive friction.

I. Content Problem: Users Can't Find the Right Tax Language

Government tax websites provide critical services, yet research and user interviews revealed that many residents struggle to pay their taxes because they cannot locate the correct pages. Our research indicated that the existing site structure is not intuitive enough for users to navigate successfully, often leading to frustration and a reliance on external help.

II. Content Strategy: Conversational Guidance Over Navigation

I led the design of **AskBC**, a conversational AI prototype that guides users directly to relevant tax information and payment flows. Rather than a static search bar, the chatbot uses guided conversation to bridge fragmented government resources.

III. Writing the Conversation: Progressive Disclosure Through Language

The primary goal was to create a customized tax payment flow based on individual user input. I designed the conversation language to guide users through a specific sequence of questions, using clear prompts and plain language to reduce cognitive load at each step.

- **Intentional Question Design:** Each prompt asks for only one decision at a time (e.g., filing status, residency), helping users stay oriented.
- **Customized Outcomes:** By processing this information, the chatbot navigates the user to a personalized guide, ensuring they reach the correct destination for their specific tax liability.
- **Structural Impact:** This design replaced complex, multi-level menu navigation with a direct, conversational path, significantly reducing the cognitive effort required to find specific tax credits.

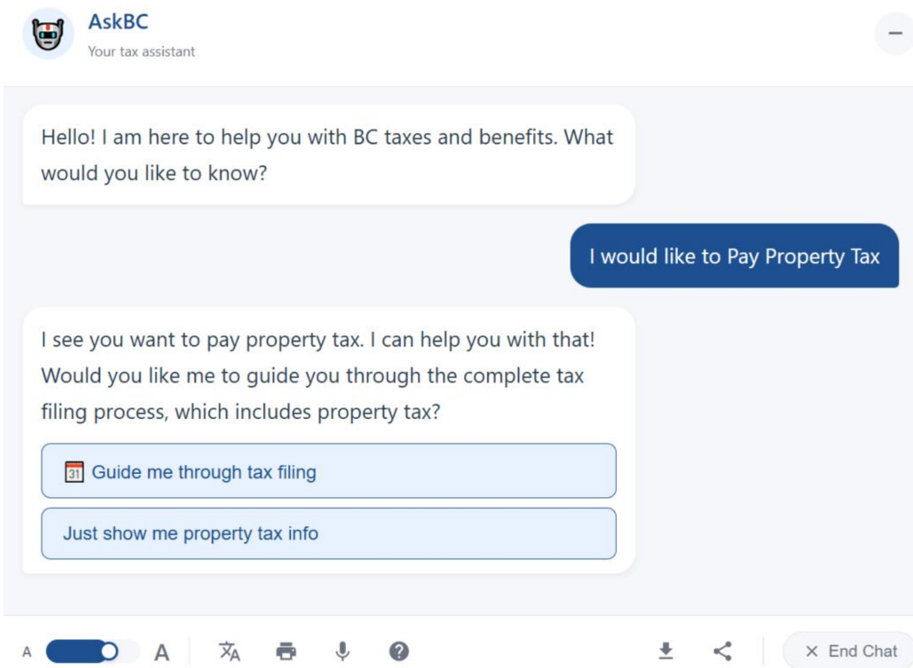

Figure 3.1 – Intentional Question Design

IV. Designing Trust Through Microcopy

While the personalized navigation was our primary focus, user interviews highlighted a critical concern regarding data security. Participants were hesitant to share the personal details required for the customized flow without clear assurances of privacy.

- **The Design Intervention & Language:** I introduced a **Confidentiality Checkbox** at the start of the data-collection phase, paired with concise, transparent language confirming that user information would be used only to personalize navigation.
- **The Result:** This simple addition allowed users to feel secure in providing the data necessary to unlock the customized navigation experience.

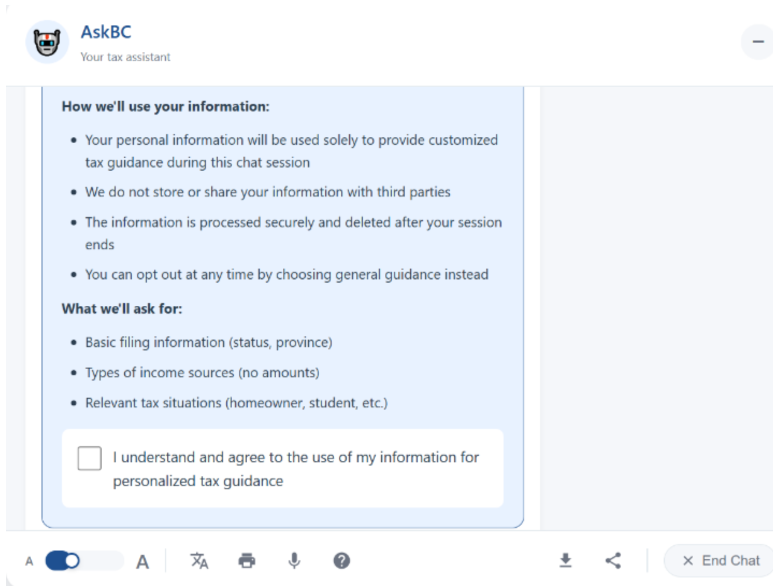

Figure 4.1 – Confidentiality Checkbox

Example In-Product Microcopy

"The information you provide will only be used to personalize your tax guidance during this session. Your data will not be stored or shared with third parties."

This copy was intentionally concise and transparent to reduce hesitation at the moment users were asked to share sensitive information.

V. Impact: How Language Improved Task Success

By prioritizing clear, conversational language and predictable responses, the experience reduced confusion and increased user confidence.

- **Task Success:** Task completion rates rose from 50% to 75%.
- **Time Efficiency:** Average time-to-information dropped from 5 minutes to 2 minutes.
- **Usability:** Users reported a higher sense of confidence when navigated to pages tailored to their specific status.

Through this project, I saw how small language decisions—when timed and framed carefully—can meaningfully improve usability and user confidence within complex systems.